

PC; they are really good at service”, and with its network of service centres: “HP has got best networks, as its quality of service.” Does the higher cost of an HP computer scare away customers? Not if Qasim Zaidi, a software engineer from New Delhi, has a say in it: “HP products

may be a bit expensive, but the after-sales service more than makes up for it.” HP computers also scored high on reliability, beaten only by assembled computers. They did take a beating on the Service Index, mainly due to the fact that customers were not very satisfied

by the technical aptitude of service personnel—“the HP dealers should have well qualified engineers”, pointed out one respondent. HCL scored well in this particular field, and shared the highest Service Index along with assembled computers.

Digital Cameras

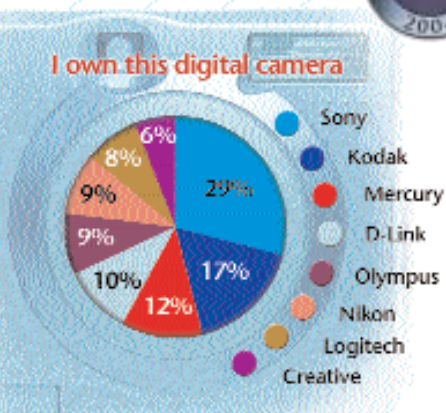
Winner for digital cameras is **NIKON**



Digital cameras are widely regarded as one of the most reliable consumer electronics products. When the user interface consists mainly of pointing and shooting, and the mechanics involve no moving parts, it is easy to believe that notion. Furthermore, the belief finds support from our survey.

To begin with, the space of digital cameras saw the largest representation in the form of companies—Sony, Kodak, Nikon, Olympus and Creative were just a few of the vendors represented here. This showcases an interesting point—that as far as digital cameras are concerned, no single company has an unshaken hold over the market. Not surprisingly, Sony garnered the most votes, whereas Creative ended up with the least count—a reflection on how photographers, both professional and amateurs, think in terms of brands.

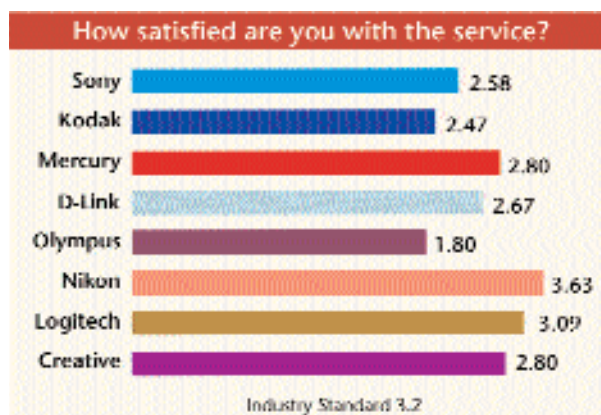
But brand-strength does not necessarily reflect upon reliability or consumer satisfaction. This fact was showcased by the fact that Nikon scored the highest on both the Relia-



common problem plagued users across brands—battery. This was either in terms of a faulty battery, or a bemoaning a low battery-life. The latter case being even more prominent with users of cameras with LCD screens. Some low-end solutions from Logitech were censured for the slow refresh rates of their CMOS lenses. On the software front, drivers and companion software were the cause of problems, “My Logitech camera is nice, but I experience problems with the software that they have provided”, Sudhir, a student, pointed out.

Superb product, but eats a lot of battery when the LCD is used

Priyanka Mukherjee, on her Olympus camera
Calcutta, West Bengal



bility and Service Indices, beating Sony by a whisker. Never mind the fact that 98 per cent of Sony users said that they will buy the product again as opposed to 87 per cent of Nikon users, who had a similar view.

In terms of hardware, a

After Nikon, Logitech consumers were the most satisfied with their cameras; customers of Creative complained about lack of after-sales support. Olympus users were the least satisfied with their cameras

MOST RELIABLE DIGITAL CAMERA: Nikon RUNNER-UP: Sony
MOST SATISFACTORY SERVICE: Nikon RUNNER-UP: Logitech